Language Study

Commonplace
Composition

SAMPLE

Alveary

©2026 Charlotte Mason Institute® All rights reserved.

About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Composition: Grade 12, Commonplace: Grades 9-12

About Commonplace: Grades 9-12
Building on the habit of copywork in younger grades, high school students copy passages of any length that strike them from their readings into their commonplace book. For some students, this becomes a lifelong keepsake and continuing habit.

About Composition: Grade 12
Students continue to build experience with multiple forms of writing and practice healthy writing habits. This course especially focuses on the ethical dimension of words today, the role of technology, and the craft of research and academic writing, so students learn to show the significance of their ideas within a scholarly conversation.

Composition: Grade 12
In addition to their composition and grammar lessons, students should continue to keep track of their regular written narrations and write 5-10 each week. Not all narrations need to be lengthy, but students should be comfortable typing multiple paragraphs if given the time.

Placement & Combining Tips

Commonplace: Grades 9-12
Students new to copywork or keeping a commonplace book may want to schedule this during morning lessons to build the habit.

Composition: Grade 12
Prerequisite: Students with little background in the essay form should begin with Essay Voyage from the Grade 9 lessons.

Students new to the concept of revision and editing should take the Grade 10 lessons through Style: The Basics of Clarity and Grace and may want to substitute the other revision/editing lessons in Grade 10 to build their skills.

Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
9-12	Commonplace: Grades 9-12 1+ time/week 10 min	
12	Composition: Grade 12 4 times/week 40 min	Advanced Academic Writing II Teacher Manual Caring for Words in a Culture of Lies (2nd ed.) The Craft of Research

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Language Study: Grade 12				
Composition: Grade 12	Composition: Grade 12	Composition: Grade 12	Commonplace: Grades 9-12	Composition: Grade 12

SAMPLE

©2026 Charlotte Mason Institute® All rights reserved.

Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Composition: Grade 12
☐ One purpose of composition lessons is to encourage you, the student, to dig deeper, self-reflect on your own thoughts and writing, and learn how to ask good questions of yourself and your readings. It isn't about proving to your teacher that you read a book or did an assignment.

☐ Set the timer and use the whole time allotted for a lesson. If you finish an assignment with extra time, explore another perspective, ask further questions, or take a bit more time to see if any other thoughts come to mind. Alternately, if you find yourself stuck, you may want to take a short break and come back later, or break up the time into two shorter times. Growth, not frustration, is the goal.

Term Prep & Teacher Tips

Composition: Grade 12
☐ Plan to have your student(s) type the majority of their narrations and compositions. See keyboarding course for resources on typing if needed.

☐ Encourage students to spend all the time left at the end of a lesson on their written narrations and the whole lesson time on their compositions, and give as much detail as possible. For their narrations, it may help if you encourage them to think of writing their narrations for a friend or someone who has never read the book, rather than for you, who might already know the story. If they feel like they've run out of things to write, have them try varying the type of narration they're writing (interview, sketch, letter, poem, etc.).

Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.
∞ View Book List Details

Language Study: Grade 12

Composition: Grade 12


Advanced Academic Writing II Teacher Manual



Caring for Words in a Culture of Lies (2nd ed.)



The Craft of Research

Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.
∞ View Basic Supplies

SAMPLE

©2026 Charlotte Mason Institute® All rights reserved.

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)

Quick Links

Language Study: Grade 12

- Extra Helpings
- Foundations (See Sections 3 & 8: Narration & English)

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.

SAMPLE

©2026 Charlotte Mason Institute® All rights reserved.

Language Study: Grade 12

How To Approach



Read

You will read books across the curriculum. Look for interesting quotes to copy into your commonplace book!



Practice

You will practice many forms of composition over the year. Your books will often serve as the foundation for your assignments, along with books specifically focused on composition.



Teacher Note

- As you review your students' composition assignments, be sure to read the instructions in the lesson and give feedback and support accordingly.
- Some students naturally integrate and incorporate ideas from grammar and composition lessons into their narrations and composition assignments, but most assignments ask students to focus on one skill or idea.
- For editing or revision lessons, hold the student accountable to work through the process and instructions given for editing, but refrain from suggesting too many ideas about how they could expand the essay or add another idea.
- For assignments that ask a student to focus on a particular concept, ignore spelling or grammar edits, and support your student by noticing what they've done well and drawing out ideas on how to dig deeper.

SAMPLE

©2026 Charlotte Mason Institute® All rights reserved.

Language Study: Grade 12

Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.

Term 1

WEEK 1

⬚ 40m Composition: Grade 12 - Lesson 1

Materials: Caring for Words

→ NOTE
You will be reading this book over all three terms. Do an inspectional reading before you begin reading today. Look at the front and back, cover material, chapter titles, etc.

→ READ & NARRATE
"An Introductory Word to Readers" & p.1-top of p.7

• Narrate in a variety of ways throughout the term.

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE
In addition to these more formal composition lessons, be sure to keep up the habit of written and oral narrations throughout the week. Aim for 8-10 written narrations per week, and use different ways of narrating to keep it interesting!

WEEK 1

⬚ 40m Composition: Grade 12 - Lesson 2

Materials: Advanced Academic Writing II

→ INTRO
What is the value of writing? Of poetry, stories, essays, and biographies? Jot down your thoughts.

→ REVIEW
You've learned about structure before, but it's worth reviewing as you begin another year.
Advanced Academic Writing II
p.1,4-5

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
As you practice and read many different forms of writing over the year, continue to consider the questions at the beginning of this lesson. Consider this short story by J.R.R. Tolkien in light of these questions.
∞ Story Link: Leaf by Niggle

• Why did Niggle have such a hard time finishing his painting?
• What were some of Niggle's biggest regrets in the hospital-prison?
• Tolkien wrote this story before publishing his masterpiece, The Lord of the Rings. Do you think he might have given the story a different ending if he had written it afterwards? Why or why not?

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE
You may write or type your narrations and compositions initially. But for these composition lessons, be sure to type the final draft you turn in to your teacher.

WEEK 1

⬚ 40m Composition: Grade 12 - Lesson 3
Questions

→ INTRO
Charlotte Mason said that we only know what we ask ourselves questions about and then can communicate to ourselves and others. She called all the different ways that we can narrate "forms of vitality." Here are her actual words:

One thing at any rate we know with certainty, that no teaching, no information becomes knowledge to any of us until the individual mind has acted upon it, translated it, transformed, absorbed it, to reappear, like our bodily food, in forms of vitality. Therefore, teaching, talk, and tale, however lucid or fascinating, affect nothing until self-activity is set up; that is, self-education is the only possible education; the rest is mere veneer laid on the surface of a child's nature (Vol. 6, p.240).

This is how we know and why we narrate. We help ourselves along in this process by developing the habit of asking good questions. A famous scientist named Louis Agassiz was a master at helping students see and observe more by learning to ask themselves questions about whatever they were studying. Read the account of one of his students when first

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE
If you have read this article before, skip to the WRITE assignment or complete the whole lesson to refresh your memory. It's a good reminder!

SAMPLE

©2026 Charlotte Mason Institute® All rights reserved.

Term 1

being examined for the opportunity.

→ READ
p.96-100 "The examination"- "knowledge of fossils."
∞ Article Link: Autobiography of Nathaniel Shaler

→ WRITE
Write as many observations and questions about one of your readings as you have time for.

WEEK 1 ⬚ **40m Composition: Grade 12 - Lesson 4**
Tech/Visual

→ CREATE
Sometimes a "picture is worth a thousand words." Use this lesson to create an infographic by hand or in Canva, PowerPoint, or another design software. Look at some of the coffee infographics in the attached article to get a sense for the possibilities. Whether created digitally or by hand, visual illustrations are a powerful narration tool as well to help you understand what you read, so feel free to incorporate visuals into your daily narrations!

First, brainstorm what you want to illustrate. Here are some ideas:
• Show the process to conduct a science lab
• Key events in your life or the life of a historical character you're reading about.
• Outline a sermon you've heard or key points from a chapter in one of your books.
• Your daily or weekly schedule
• Your family tree.
• Something else entirely!
• How to make your favorite recipe

∞ Article Link: Coffee Infographic

WEEK 2 ⬚ **40m Composition: Grade 12 - Lesson 5**

Materials: Caring for Words

→ READ & NARRATE
p.7-middle of p.13
Narrate in a variety of ways.

WEEK 2 ⬚ **40m Composition: Grade 12 - Lesson 6**

→ INTRO
Have you ever thought about the way that narration could equip you to work in business, marketing, web design, or another profession?

→ READ/VIEW, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
Story is fundamental to the nature of reality. So it is surprising that stories are part of our lives from childhood through adulthood? Explore 1-2 of these resources which explain the ways stories move us and show how stories are an effective piece of many professions.

∞ Article Link: Storytelling that moves people
∞ Video Link: The magic of storytelling
∞ Article Link: Storytelling and marketing

→ ACTIVITY
• Analyze several websites. Do they tell a story on their intro pages? What

SAMPLE

©2026 Charlotte Mason Institute® All rights reserved.

Term 1

is it?
• Count how many times you tell a story today (a story as simple as who you saw at the grocery store still counts!).

WEEK 2 ⬚ **40m Composition: Grade 12 - Lesson 7**
Poetry

→ WRITE
Compose a poem that tells a story (either one you made up or a retelling of something you've read). Use the epic convention of starting "in media res" or in the middle of the action. For instance, if you are telling the story of your day, start with the moment you looked out the window and saw a hawk eat a worm, not the moment you woke up.

Give your poem an intentional structure and label what it is (refer back to Making of a Poem from Grade 9 Poetry study for a list of forms if desired).

WEEK 2 ⬚ **40m Composition: Grade 12 - Lesson 8**
Inspection

→ WRITE
Gather 3 of your favorite books from the term so far, and reread the first few pages of each. Where does each author begin? How do they draw you into the story? What details do you notice in just the first few pages that give you a clue to what time period you're reading about, who the main character(s) is/are, what the purpose of the book is, what the genre is, and the author's style? Write down your findings.

Think about a few of your other favorite books in general. What about them grabs your attention? Add to your findings.

WEEK 3 ⬚ **40m Composition: Grade 12 - Lesson 9**

Materials: Caring for Words

→ READ & NARRATE
p.13-21
Narrate in a variety of ways.

WEEK 3 ⬚ **40m Composition: Grade 12 - Lesson 10**
→ INTRO
Writing and speaking are closely tied together. Often, something that starts in writing becomes part of a conversation or an oral presentation. Conversely, an idea shared over a meal or in a lecture could grow into a book. Just as we can grow as writers, we can grow as speakers. Today, listen to an oral storyteller and observe the ways she uses her voice, gestures, tone, and words to effectively tell a story.

→ VIEW, NARRATE, & DISCUSS
∞ Video Link: The Camel Driver
Time Marker 5:45-end

• Were you sucked into the story? How did Jan Blake draw you in?
• What are the ingredients of an effective story? What new options does an oral format provide? What unique options does a written format provide an author?

WEEK 3 ⬚ **40m Composition: Grade 12 - Lesson 11**
Revision

→ INTRO
Good writers revise. Sometimes we imagine a writer sitting at a desk,

• STUDENT TIP
Especially if revision is new to you, consider purchasing Style: The Basics of Clarity and Grace (used in Grade 10) to keep as a reference.

SAMPLE

©2026 Charlotte Mason Institute® All rights reserved.

Term 1

scribbling away furiously - complete sentences, and vivid lines of poetry or prose magically appearing on their paper, instantly ready for publication. Unfortunately, as author Anne Lamott describes, "almost all good writing begins with terrible first efforts. You need to start somewhere. Start by getting something - anything - down on paper. A friend of mine says that the first draft is the down draft -- you just get it down. The second draft is the up draft - you fix it up. You try to say what you have to say more accurately. And the third draft is the dental draft, where you check every tooth, to see if it's loose or cramped or decayed, or even, ... healthy" (Bird by Bird 24).

→ DISCUSS
Read this short blog on revision. What ideas are new to you? You might not agree with everything the author says, but take note of his main points.
∞ Article Link: On Revision

→ REVISE
Pick a previous narration that is at least two paragraphs long to revise and rewrite. Your goal is not just to make your writing free of punctuation or spelling errors, but to create a more polished version of your narration that you could share with someone to tell them about the particular topic you wrote about or the chapter you read.

Big-Picture Revision
1. If you have not already typed your narration, do that now so you have a digital version to edit.
2. Are there other ideas you've had more recently that you'd like to add to your narration? Do that now.
3. Look at your paragraphs. Are they intended and focused around one idea each? Describe that main idea in one sentence and consider making that the first sentence of your paragraph.
4. Try moving your paragraphs around in a different order. What order do you think might make the most sense to someone reading your words?

Sentence Level Revision
1. Read your narration aloud and fix any grammar or spelling errors you hear or see.
2. Make main characters the subjects of sentences and important action verbs where possible.
3. How well do your sentences flow? Put old information before new information in your sentences.
4. Delete unnecessary words and change negatives to affirmatives.
5. Make sure your sentences are complete, not fragments.
6. Use Grammarly or another spell checker to find any other punctuation or spelling issues and fix those.

WEEK 3 ⬚ **40m Composition: Grade 12 - Lesson 12**
Point of View

→ WRITE
Write a narration as if you are inside the story and telling a first-hand account of what you're seeing! For instance, perhaps you're walking alongside Rama, observing all the happenings in Paradise Lost, traveling in South America to measure the earth, or visiting another character in history. You can write it as a diary entry and tell your thoughts as you walk around inside the story. Or you could write it as a travel memoir and focus on describing what is going on to your audience. In either case, tell things from your first-person perspective.

SAMPLE

©2026 Charlotte Mason Institute® All rights reserved.